

Chapter 50-3

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Qiu Zimin ended this farce with fainting.

The atmosphere in the house became strange and tense. As the person involved, Liang Shi left the third-floor room after hearing that Qiu Zimin had only fainted from being too emotionally agitated.

She left the space to them.

She didn't care how Qiu Zimin would slander her.

Anyway, what the original host had left for everyone was never a positive image.

However, she should be able to move back to the original villa tomorrow, then go look for a house.

She probably wouldn't be able to stay in the Liang family much longer.

It depended on whether Qiu Zimin would completely tear off the facade.

After she left, Liang Xinzhou followed her out.

Liang Shi smiled bitterly, "Big brother, what's the matter?"

Liang Xinzhou glanced at her shoulder, paused for a few seconds before saying: "All these years, I've always treated you as my real little sister."

"Did you know I'm not a child of the Liang family?" Liang Shi suddenly asked him.

Liang Xinzhou pressed his lips together and told the truth: "I knew."

This surprised Liang Shi.

She wondered: "Then why are you still so good to me?"

She wasn't even a real sister.

This was being too sympathetic.

Liang Xinzhou stood there and said gently: "Let's go outside to talk."

Behind the villa was a large garden, where the gardener had trimmed it into various shapes.

Even in autumn, it was still full of blooming flowers.

However, autumn nights were cold. Liang Shi wrapped her coat tighter around herself but still sneezed.

Liang Xinzhou took off his own coat and handed it to her.

Liang Shi originally wanted to decline, but swallowed the words the second they were about to come out. She reached out to accept the coat, changing all her distant words into one sentence: "Thank you."

"I had a real little sister." Liang Xinzhou said: "The same age as you, not much different."

"But after father took her out, she was stolen when he got distracted and didn't watch her carefully. At that time, mom and dad's condition was very bad. We searched for a long time but couldn't find little sister. Until one day, mom brought you back from somewhere. You were even smaller than my little sister, but mom treated you as third little sister, and only then did the family atmosphere improve."

Liang Xinzhou was a steady person. When talking about these matters, he tried to narrate from an objective angle without deliberately favoring anyone.

"I know that mom and dad have been looking for third little sister all these years. But for me, you're someone who once saved our family, and you were only this big when you came to our house." Liang Xinzhou gestured with his hand, "Just a tiny bundle. To be honest, you're prettier than our family's third little sister. When Xinhui saw you, he kept clamoring to hold you. He was young then and didn't remember things, so he thought you were our real little sister."

Liang Shi listened to him talk about childhood events, and could picture the scenes in her mind.

"You were very well-behaved." Liang Xinzhou said: "You hardly ever cried or made a fuss. Ever since you came, Xinhui often said little sister had become well-behaved and didn't cry much anymore. And you loved to smile back then, your eyes would curve when you smiled."

"I watched you grow up from a few months old. I was the one who held your hand to practice walking, and I watched you learn to run. After you learned to speak, the first thing you called was 'brother'—I don't know if you were calling me or Xinhui." Mentioning these things, Liang Xinzhou's face showed a smile, "I was the one who sent you to kindergarten on your first day. The kindergarten teachers all praised how well-behaved you were."

"Later, although you became very rebellious, you were still very obedient at home." Liang Xinzhou said: "I would occasionally lament that my little sister had gone astray, mixing with those spoiled rich kids for no reason, but I never thought of not treating you as my sister. Moreover, recently my little sister's rebellious phase has passed, and she's become as well-behaved as when she was little. I'm very relieved."

"If possible, I hope you never have to know that you're not mom and dad's child in this lifetime." Liang Xinzhou said: "I would take this secret to my grave, even if my real little sister came back."

Listening to this, Liang Shi felt her nose tingle, and a tear fell.

She looked at Liang Xinzhou's profile, "Big brother, I once hoped for that too."

But Qiu Zimin was two-faced. If she didn't make things clear with her now, there would be endless troubles later.

She didn't want to live a life on tenterhooks.

Moreover, the original host had suffered so much injustice over the years—she deserved justice.

"So don't overthink it." Liang Xinzhou said: "You were our little sister before, and you'll still be our little sister in the future."

Liang Shi smiled, "I'm afraid mom doesn't think so."

Taking a walk, they returned to the villa entrance.

Liang Shi returned the coat to Liang Xinzhou, "Big brother, I can only say that mom's treatment of me isn't like what you see on the surface. If one day I sever ties with the Liang family, I'll still remember the kindness you and second brother showed me. I hope that even if we can't be siblings, we can still be friends."

Just, don't be enemies.

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When Liang Shi returned to her room, she was exhausted.

This kind of psychological fatigue spread to her body.

She leaned against the door to rest for quite a while before heavily exhaling, expelling all the bad emotions.

When she opened her eyes again, she found Xu Qingzhu looking at her.

"..."

"Are you alright?" Xu Qingzhu asked.

Liang Shi nodded: "Unexpected, but reasonable."

"She's quite good at acting." Xu Qingzhu said flatly.

Although they had experienced such an incident tonight, after experiencing Qiu Zimin's matter, the two seemed to return to a time when they could get along peacefully. The atmosphere was finally not awkward anymore.

Liang Shi smiled helplessly, "If she couldn't act, how could everyone have been deceived by her for so many years."

Xu Qingzhu pressed her lips together, "Let me show you something."

Liang Shi turned her head, "What?"

Xu Qingzhu moved over, opened the bedside drawer, and took out what she had discovered in the room.

A blood-colored button, and a torn cloth doll.

Liang Shi frowned, "What is this?"

Xu Qingzhu said: "I found the button behind the door. There's human blood on it. This doll..."

She paused, flipping the doll over to reveal that the front of the doll's clothes was embroidered with two characters: Liang Shi.

And it was full of needles.

Xu Qingzhu said: "I found it in a corner under the bed."

Liang Shi: "..."

Just how superstitious was this Qiu Zimin?!

No, how much did she hate her?

"I suspect it's a kind of witchcraft." Xu Qingzhu said: "But I had a friend appraise it, and she said this was purely for venting anger, with no actual effect."

Liang Shi: "..."